PERSONAL TRAINING PROGRAM · BUILT FOR KIRAN

4-DAY FULL BODY PROGRAM (OPTIMIZED)

Built for muscle size, aesthetics and strength during a cut. Every muscle is trained 2-4x per week with enough weekly volume to grow, using the best-proven exercises for each muscle. No dropsets, no gimmicks - just heavy, progressive, simple training you can stay consistent with.

4 / week	2-4x	9-12	60-70 min
TRAINING DAYS	FREQUENCY PER MUSCLE	WEEKLY SETS / MAJOR MUSCLE	PER SESSION

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Full Body 1 Quads, Chest & Back	**Full Body 2** Hamstrings, Back & Chest	**Rest**	**Full Body 3** Quads, Shoulders & Arms	**Rest**	**Full Body 4** Single-Leg, Back Width & Grip	**Rest**

MUSCLE GROUP KEY

Legs · Calves · Chest · Back · Shoulders · Arms · Abs · Forearms

What changed vs. your previous plan: more hamstring, triceps, chest and calf volume; one overhead press instead of two (front delts were overloaded); dropsets replaced with straight sets; jump squats replaced by heavy compound lifts; forearm and ab work simplified to the movements that matter; every day rebalanced to 8-10 exercises.

00 Warm-Up Protocol & How To Read

Every session, before exercise 1

General pre-workout warm-up

1. **5 min cardio** - treadmill, bike or rower, raise your heart rate to ~130 bpm. Raises core and joint temperature before anything is loaded.
2. **Arm swings** - both directions, 10 each way. Loosens the shoulders before pressing and pulling.
3. **Leg cross swings** - 10 each leg, side to side across the body. Opens the hips before squat, lunge and hinge patterns.

No dedicated warm-up needed for

- Isolation work (curls, raises, extensions, calves, abs, forearms). Your first working set at a slightly conservative weight *is* the warm-up. Your first heavy compound lift of the day has already raised core temperature.
- Bodyweight squat to prime the movement is optional before Day 1 / Day 3 leg exercises (1 set, slow, 8-10 reps).

Warm-up set ramping guide

PRESCRIBED WARM-UPS	RAMP	% OF TOP SET	REPS
1 set	Set 1	60-70%	8-10
2 sets	Set 1 Set 2	50% 75%	8 5
2-3 sets	Set 1 Set 2 Set 3	50% 70% 85%	8 5 2-3

Why this order matters

Ramping warm-ups prepare joints, tendons and the nervous system for the top working weight without burning fatigue you need for the set itself. Don't grind warm-up sets - they're rehearsal, not work. On new movements (forearm work, ab wheel, hanging leg raise), start conservative for the first 2 weeks regardless of the prescribed RPE: tendons adapt slower than muscle.

How to read the tables

Superset tags (A1 / A2)

Exercises tagged A1 and A2 are done back-to-back with 0 rest between them, then you take the rest listed on the A2 row before repeating the pair. Supersets save about 10-15 minutes per session without hurting performance because the two exercises train different muscles.

Video links

- **WATCH** = a video link carried over from your original program (same exercise).
- **SEARCH VIDEO** = opens a YouTube search for that exercise (new exercises with no verified video link). Pick a tutorial from a reputable coach, ideally one with a clear demonstration of setup and range of motion.

What RPE means

VALUE	MEANING (REPS LEFT IN THE TANK)
7-8	3-2 reps left - used only in the first 1-2 weeks of a new movement
8-9	2-1 reps left - heavy compound sets
9-10	1 or fewer reps left - most sets in this program
10	True failure - cannot complete another rep with good form

Instead of dropsets

On isolation exercises, take the **last set** to true failure (RPE 10). Same effect, simpler, less fatigue.

01 Weekly Volume & Intensity

Hard sets per muscle per week, and how hard to train

MUSCLE	SETS / WEEK	FREQ.	WHERE (DAY: SETS)	MAIN REP RANGE	STATUS
Quads	12	4x	D1 Hack Squat 3 - D2 Leg Ext 3 - D3 Leg Press 3 - D4 Bulgarian 3	6-15	Optimal
Hamstrings	9	3x	D1 Leg Curl 3 - D2 RDL 3 - D3 Leg Curl 3 (+ split squat)	8-12	Optimal
Glutes	~12 (indirect)	4x	RDL, hack/leg press, Bulgarian split squat	6-12	Optimal
Chest	11	3x	D1 Incline 3 - D2 Flat 3 - D4 Incline 2 + Fly 3	6-15	Optimal
Back (lats + upper back)	12	4x	D1 Pulldown 3 - D2 Row 3 - D3 Row 3 - D4 Pull-Up 3	6-12	Optimal
Side delts	8	3x	D1 Cable 3 - D3 DB 3 - D4 DB 2	12-20	Good (+ pressing)
Rear delts	6	2x	D2 Reverse Pec Deck 3 - D4 Face Pull 3 (+ rows)	12-20	Good
Front delts	3 direct	1x	D3 Seated DB Press 3 (+ ~14 sets of pressing)	6-10	Covered by pressing
Biceps	9 direct	3x	D1 Preacher 3 - D2 Incline Curl 3 - D3 Hammer 3 (+ back work)	8-12	Optimal
Triceps	9 direct	3x	D1 Overhead 3 - D2 Pushdown 3 - D4 Overhead 3 (+ pressing)	10-15	Optimal
Forearms / grip	9	3x	D3 Hammer 3 + Wrist Curl 3 - D4 Farmer Carry 3	10-20	Good
Calves	9	3x	D1 Standing 3 - D3 Seated 3 - D4 Standing 3	8-15	Good (see notes)
Abs	9	3x	D1 Cable Crunch 3 - D2 Leg Raise 3 - D4 Ab Wheel 3	8-15	Good

Volume guidelines this plan follows

- **Effective range:** roughly 10-20 hard sets per muscle per week builds muscle best; 6-9 maintains and grows slowly; under 6 is minimal.
- **Smaller muscles** (delts, arms, calves) respond to frequent, smaller doses (3-4x/week).
- **A "hard set"** is one taken to 0-2 reps from failure. Easy sets with 4+ reps left do not count.
- **Sessions:** Day 1 = 27 sets, Day 2 = 24, Day 3 = 24, Day 4 = 28. About 60-70 minutes each.

Intensity map

LIFT TYPE	REPS	RPE
Heavy compounds (hack squat/leg press, incline press, RDL, pull-up, overhead press)	6-10	8-9
Rows, pulldowns, flat press, split squat	8-12	9-10
Isolation (curls, extensions, leg curl/ext, fly)	10-15	9-10, last set 10
Side/rear delts, calves, forearms	12-20	9-10

01 Full Body 1

Quads, Chest & Back - Heavy Strength Day

LEGS | CHEST | BACK | HAMSTRINGS | SHOULDERS | ARMS | CALVES | ABS

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
1	**Hack Squat (or Leg Press)** LEGS Quads - Glutes WATCH *Feet shoulder-width and low on the platform. Lower under control for 2-3 sec to deep range (thighs at or below parallel) with your back and hips glued to the pad. Drive up through the mid-foot without slamming the knees into lockout. On a leg press, use the same low/narrow foot position and never let the lower back round off the pad. Add weight or reps every week.* **Subs:** Leg Press, Smith Machine Squat, Goblet Squat	3 x 6-8	2-3	8-9	~3 min
2	**Incline DB Press (heavy)** CHEST Upper Chest - sec. Front Delt, Triceps WATCH *Bench at 30-45 degrees. Pull shoulder blades back and down, DBs over the upper chest. Lower for 2-3 sec to a deep stretch with elbows ~45-60 degrees from the torso, then press up and slightly together. A steeper bench shifts load to front delts, so stay at 30-45.* **Subs:** Machine Incline Press, Smith Incline Press, Flat DB Press	3 x 6-8	2-3	8-9	~3 min
3	**Neutral-Grip Lat Pulldown** BACK Lats - sec. Biceps, Rear Delt WATCH *Lean back slightly, chest up. Pull elbows down and into your sides (think elbows to back pockets), squeeze the lats, then let the bar rise slowly until your lats are fully stretched. No swinging or body English.* **Subs:** Wide Lat Pulldown, Assisted Pull-Up, Machine Pulldown	3 x 8-10	2	9-10	~2 min
4	**Seated Leg Curl** LEGS Hamstrings WATCH *Set the pad just above your heels and the thigh pad snug. Curl all the way, hold the squeeze 1 sec, then take 3 sec to return to a full stretch. The seated version stretches the hamstrings more than lying, which is better for growth.* **Subs:** Lying Leg Curl, Stability-Ball Curl, Nordic Curl (assisted)	3 x 10-12	1	9-10	~2 min
5	**Cable Lateral Raise** SHOULDERS Side Delt SEARCH VIDEO *Cable at the lowest setting, stand side-on, work one arm at a time. Slight lean away, soft elbow. Lead with the elbow (not the hand) out to shoulder height, then lower slowly. The cable keeps tension on the delt at the bottom where dumbbells give none.* **Subs:** DB Lateral Raise, Lean-Away Cable Lateral Raise	3 x 12-15	-	9-10	~1.5 min

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
6	**A1 Overhead Cable Triceps Extension** ARMS Triceps (long head) WATCH *Rope on a mid/high pulley, face away, hands by your ears, elbows pointing forward and kept still. Extend fully, then lower slowly to a deep stretch behind the head. Overhead work trains the largest tricep head, so it is done 2x per week.* **Subs:** DB Overhead Extension, EZ-Bar Skull Crusher, French Press	3 x 10-12	-	9-10	0 min
7	**A2 Preacher Curl** ARMS Biceps (short head) - Brachialis SEARCH VIDEO *Armpits snug on the pad. Lower slowly to near full extension (do not slam into lockout), then curl up without letting the elbows lift. Use an EZ bar or the preacher machine. The bottom stretch is where this lift builds muscle, so do not shorten it.* **Subs:** Machine Preacher Curl, Cable Preacher Curl, EZ-Bar Curl	3 x 8-12	-	9-10	~1.5 min
8	**Standing Calf Raise** CALVES Gastrocnemius (calf shape) SEARCH VIDEO *Drop your heels as low as possible, pause 2 sec in the full stretch, then rise onto the balls of your feet and squeeze. No bouncing. Go heavy: calves handle a lot of load.* **Subs:** Leg Press Toe Press, Smith Machine Calf Raise, Single-Leg DB Calf Raise	3 x 8-12	-	9-10	~1.5 min
9	**Cable Crunch** ABS Rectus Abdominis WATCH *Kneel under a rope pulley, hands by your head. Curl your ribs toward your pelvis by rounding the spine - hips stay still. Pull with the abs, not by hinging at the hips.* **Subs:** Machine Crunch, Plate-Weighted Crunch	3 x 10-15	-	9-10	~1 min

02 Full Body 2

Hamstrings, Back & Chest Volume

LEGS BACK CHEST SHOULDERS ARMS ABS

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
1	**Romanian Deadlift** LEGS Hamstrings - Glutes - sec. Lower Back WATCH *Neutral spine, soft knees. Push your hips back, keep the bar against your legs, and lower until you feel a strong hamstring stretch (around mid-shin). Drive the hips forward to stand. The moment your lower back starts to round, that is the end of the set.* **Subs:** DB Romanian Deadlift, Smith Machine RDL, 45-Degree Hyperextension	3 x 8-10	2	8-9	~2-3 min
2	**Seated Cable Row (V-bar / close grip)** BACK Mid-Back - Lats - sec. Biceps WATCH *Sit tall with a slight forward lean at the start. Pull the handle to your lower ribs, squeeze the shoulder blades together for 1 sec, then stretch forward under control. After RDLs, keep your torso still - no rocking. This is your chest-supported-row replacement (no machine needed).* **Subs:** Incline-Bench Chest-Supported DB Row (lie face down on a 30-45 degree bench), T-Bar Row, One-Arm Cable Row	3 x 8-10	2	9-10	~2 min
3	**Flat DB Press** CHEST Mid/Lower Chest - sec. Front Delt, Triceps WATCH *Shoulder blades pinned back and down, slight arch, feet planted. Lower for 2-3 sec to a deep stretch, press up powerfully. Never let the dumbbells crash into the bottom stretch.* **Subs:** Machine Chest Press, Weighted Dip, Barbell Bench Press	3 x 8-10	2	9-10	~2 min
4	**Leg Extension** LEGS Quads (incl. rectus femoris) SEARCH VIDEO *Align your knees with the machine pivot. Extend fully and squeeze 1 sec, then lower for 3 sec. Best exercise for the rectus femoris, which squats and presses barely train.* **Subs:** Sissy Squat, Spanish Squat (band), Single-Leg Extension	3 x 10-15	-	9-10	~1.5 min
5	**Reverse Pec Deck** SHOULDERS Rear Delt - sec. Mid-Traps WATCH *Chest against the pad, light grip. Swing the arms out and slightly back, leading with the elbows, not by squeezing the handles hard. Smooth and controlled.* **Subs:** Reverse Cable Fly, Bent-Over DB Reverse Fly, Rope Face Pull	3 x 12-20	-	9-10	~1.5 min

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
6	**A1 Incline DB Curl** ARMS Biceps (long head / peak) WATCH *Bench at 45-60 degrees, arms hanging behind your torso for a deep stretch. Curl without swinging; lower slowly to full stretch. Best exercise for the long head (the biceps peak).* **Subs:** Cable Curl (low pulley, arm behind torso), Bayesian Curl, Standing DB Curl	3 x 10-12	-	9-10	0 min
7	**A2 Triceps Pushdown** ARMS Triceps (lateral head) WATCH *Elbows pinned to your sides, extend until fully locked, control the return to ~90 degrees. Rope or straight bar both work - keep your torso still.* **Subs:** Straight-Bar Pushdown, Cable Kickback, DB Kickback	3 x 10-15	-	9-10	~1.5 min
8	**Hanging Leg Raise** ABS Lower Abs - Hip Flexors SEARCH VIDEO *Hang from a bar, tilt your pelvis up (posterior tilt) and raise knees to chest or higher. Curl the pelvis, do not just swing the legs. No momentum.* **Subs:** Captain's Chair Leg Raise, Reverse Crunch, Lying Leg Raise	3 x 10-15	-	9-10	~1 min

03 Full Body 3

Quads, Shoulders, Upper Back & Arms

LEGS | SHOULDERS | BACK | ARMS | FOREARMS | CALVES

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
1	**Leg Press (mid-foot position)** LEGS Quads - Glutes - sec. Hamstrings WATCH *Feet shoulder-width, mid platform (a little higher than Day 1 for more glute/hamstring). Lower deep with your lower back flat on the pad, then drive up. Varying foot position across the week hits the legs from a different angle.* **Subs:** Hack Squat, Goblet Squat, DB Walking Lunge	3 x 8-12	2	8-9	~2 min
2	**Seated DB Shoulder Press** SHOULDERS Front/Side Delt - sec. Triceps WATCH *Bench upright at 80-90 degrees. Start with DBs at ear level, press overhead without arching, and lower under control to ear/chin height. This is your ONLY overhead press of the week - front delts already get plenty from incline and flat pressing.* **Subs:** Machine Shoulder Press, Standing DB Arnold Press, Smith Shoulder Press	3 x 6-10	2	8-9	~2-3 min
3	**Seated Cable Row (wide bar)** BACK Upper Back - Rear Delt - sec. Biceps WATCH *Use a wide overhand bar. Elbows flare ~45-60 degrees as you pull to the upper abdomen/lower chest, squeezing the upper back. The wide grip shifts emphasis from the lats (Day 2 close grip) toward upper-back width and rear delts.* **Subs:** Incline-Bench Chest-Supported DB Row, T-Bar Row, Wide Lat-Bar Row	3 x 8-12	1-2	9-10	~2 min
4	**Seated Leg Curl** LEGS Hamstrings WATCH *Same setup as Day 1: full range, 1 sec squeeze, 3 sec lowering. This is your 2nd direct hamstring-curl session of the week.* **Subs:** Lying Leg Curl, Stability-Ball Curl	3 x 10-12	1	9-10	~2 min
5	**DB Lateral Raise (standing)** SHOULDERS Side Delt WATCH *Lean forward ~10-15 degrees. Raise the DBs out and slightly forward (the scapular plane) to shoulder height with your pinkies a touch higher than thumbs. Take 3 sec to lower. DB raises are a great exercise - the only weak spot is no tension at the bottom, which the Day 1 cable version covers.* **Subs:** Cable Lateral Raise, Lean-Away Cable Lateral Raise	3 x 12-20	-	9-10	~1.5 min

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
6	**A1 Hammer Curl** ARMS Brachialis - Brachioradialis (forearm) - Biceps SEARCH VIDEO *Neutral (thumbs-up) grip, elbows pinned. Curl up, squeeze, lower slowly. Builds the brachialis (pushes the biceps up from underneath) and the brachioradialis, the big muscle on the top of the forearm. Keep wrists straight.* **Subs:** Rope Hammer Curl (cable), Cross-Body Hammer Curl, Reverse EZ-Bar Curl	3 x 10-12	-	9-10	0 min
7	**A2 Wrist Curl** FOREARMS Wrist Flexors WATCH *Forearms on a bench or thighs, palms up. Let the bar roll down to your fingertips, then curl it up through full range. Go light for the first 2 weeks - tendons adapt slowly.* **Subs:** Cable Wrist Curl, Behind-the-Back Barbell Wrist Curl	3 x 12-20	-	9-10	~1.5 min
8	**Seated Calf Raise (bent knee)** CALVES Soleus (calf width) WATCH *Knees bent at 90 degrees isolates the soleus, which sits under the gastrocnemius and adds thickness and width. Full stretch, 2-sec pause at the bottom, no bouncing.* **Subs:** Standing Calf Raise, Leg Press Toe Press	3 x 10-15	-	9-10	~1.5 min

04 Full Body 4

Single-Leg, Back Width, Chest Stretch & Grip

LEGS | BACK | CHEST | SHOULDERS | ARMS | CALVES | FOREARMS | ABS

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
1	**DB Bulgarian Split Squat** LEGS Quads - Glutes - sec. Hamstrings WATCH *Start with your weaker leg. Rear foot on a bench, squat deep with your front knee tracking over the foot. Lean slightly forward for more glutes, stay upright for more quads. Do the same reps on both legs.* **Subs:** Goblet Split Squat, Smith Split Squat, DB Walking Lunge	3 x 8-12 / leg	2	8-9	~2 min
2	**Pull-Up (or Wide Pulldown)** BACK Lats - Lower Traps - sec. Biceps SEARCH VIDEO *Overhand grip slightly wider than the shoulders. Start from a dead hang, drive elbows down toward your ribs until your chin clears the bar, and lower for 2 sec. When you can hit 10 clean reps on all sets, add weight with a belt.* **Subs:** Assisted Pull-Up, Wide Lat Pulldown (see 2-grip pulldown video), Neutral-Grip Pulldown	3 x 6-10	2	9-10	~2-3 min
3	**Incline DB Press (lighter)** CHEST Upper Chest - sec. Front Delt, Triceps WATCH *Same bench angle as Day 1, but a lighter weight and more reps. Focus on a deep stretch and a hard squeeze at the top - no bouncing out of the bottom.* **Subs:** Machine Incline Press, Flat DB Press	2 x 10-12	1	9-10	~2 min
4	**Cable Fly (low-to-high)** CHEST Upper/Inner Chest SEARCH VIDEO *Pulleys at the bottom, slight forward lean, arms slightly bent. Sweep your hands up and together to chin level and stretch back out to chest level without overstretching behind the shoulders. Your only dedicated chest isolation movement.* **Subs:** Pec Deck, Incline DB Fly, High-to-Low Cable Crossover	3 x 12-15	-	9-10	~1.5 min
5	**A1 Rope Face Pull** SHOULDERS Rear Delt - sec. Rotator Cuff WATCH *Rope at forehead height. Pull toward your face with the elbows high and wide, and rotate the hands outward at the end. Great shoulder-health insurance against all the pressing.* **Subs:** Reverse Pec Deck, Reverse Cable Fly	3 x 12-15	-	9-10	0 min
6	**A2 DB Lateral Raise (1-sec pause)** SHOULDERS Side Delt WATCH *Same movement as Day 3 with a 1-sec pause at the top of each rep for extra time under tension. Lighter weight, burn-focused finisher.* **Subs:** Cable Lateral Raise, Lean-Away Cable Lateral Raise	2 x 15-20	-	10	~1.5 min

#	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	WARM-UP SETS	RPE	REST
7	**Overhead Cable Triceps Extension** ARMS Triceps (long head) WATCH *Same as Day 1. Elbows forward and pinned, full stretch behind the head, lock out hard. Second long-head session of the week.* **Subs:** DB Overhead Extension, EZ-Bar Skull Crusher	3 x 10-12	-	9-10	~1.5 min
8	**Standing Calf Raise** CALVES Gastrocnemius (calf shape) SEARCH VIDEO *Full stretch with a 2-sec pause at the bottom, strong squeeze at the top. Second gastrocnemius session of the week.* **Subs:** Leg Press Toe Press, Smith Machine Calf Raise	3 x 8-12	-	9-10	~1.5 min
9	**Farmer Carry** FOREARMS Grip - Traps - Core SEARCH VIDEO *Pick up the heaviest DBs you can hold with good posture. Shoulders down and back, ribs stacked over hips, short quick steps. If grip is already shot, go lighter or shorter rather than losing posture.* **Subs:** Trap-Bar Carry, Suitcase Carry (one side), Dead Hang (30-45 sec)	3 x 30-40 m	-	8-9	~1 min
10	**Ab Wheel Rollout (or Cable Crunch)** ABS Rectus Abdominis - Anti-Extension Core SEARCH VIDEO *From your knees, tuck the ribs down and squeeze the glutes. Roll out only as far as your lower back stays flat, then pull back with your abs. Stop the set when your lower back starts to sag.* **Subs:** Cable Crunch, Plank, Dead Bug	3 x 8-12	-	9-10	~1 min

06 Progression, Tracking & Deloads

How to keep getting better week after week

Double progression (use this for every lift)

• Each exercise has a rep range, e.g. 3 x 8-10. Start with a weight where you reach the bottom of the range (8) at the target RPE.

• Each week, try to add 1 rep per set with the same weight. When **all sets hit the top of the range** (10, 10, 10) at the target RPE, add weight next session (2.5-5 lb / 1-2.5 kg for upper body and isolation; 5-10 lb / 2.5-5 kg for leg lifts) and return to the bottom of the range.

• **Example:** Incline DB Press 3 x 6-8. Week 1: 28 kg x 6,6,6. Week 2: 28 kg x 7,6,6. Week 3: 28 kg x 8,8,7. Week 4: 28 kg x 8,8,8 - then move up to 30 kg and start again at 6 reps.

• Form always comes first: if the weight goes up but the range of motion shrinks or the form breaks down, it doesn't count as a PR.

Log every session

• Write down exercise, weight, reps and RPE for every set (notes app, spreadsheet or a logbook). If you can't remember last week's numbers, you can't beat them.

• If a lift stalls for 3 sessions in a row, check sleep, food and stress first; then add 1 set or reduce rest; then swap the exercise for a variation (see Subs).

Deload and re-test every 5-6 weeks

• **Deload week:** keep the same exercises and weights but do 2 sets instead of 3 (about 40% fewer sets), and stop most sets at RPE 7-8. Joints, tendons and the nervous system recover - strength typically rebounds the week after.

• **Deload sooner** if bar speed and strength drop for 2 sessions in a row, joints ache, motivation drops, or sleep gets worse.

• **After the deload** restart one notch below your last top weights and rebuild for 5-6 weeks.

Evaluate your progress (once every 2-4 weeks)

• **Strength:** are your main lifts (incline press, leg press/hack squat, RDL, pull-ups, DB shoulder press) going up over 4-6 weeks? On a cut, holding strength is a win.

• **Bodyweight:** weigh yourself daily (same time, after waking, after the bathroom) and track the weekly average. Aim for a loss of ~0.25-0.75% of bodyweight per week during the cut.

• **Photos:** same lighting, same time of day, front/side/back every 2 weeks. The mirror lies; photos side by side don't.

• **Measurements:** waist (at navel), chest, shoulders, upper arm and thigh once a month. Waist falling while arms/shoulders hold or grow = it's working.

• **Lagging muscle?** After 4-6 weeks of honest effort, add 1 set per session to that muscle (+2-4 sets/week) and re-evaluate after another 3-4 weeks.

Starting weights and week-by-week ramp

• **Week 1:** use weights that leave you at RPE 7-8 (2-3 reps left) on everything. Learn the movements and write down your numbers.

• **Week 2:** bring the first working sets to RPE 8-9 on compounds. Keep new movements (forearms, ab wheel, hanging leg raise, preacher curl) at RPE 7-8.

• **Week 3 onward:** train at the RPE written in the tables and apply the progression rules in the Notes section.

07 Cutting, Nutrition & General Health

What you do outside the gym matters as much as the plan

Training while cutting (fat loss)

• Muscle is kept by **lifting heavy and progressing**, not by training more. Keep the weights and rep ranges; you may lose a few reps per set in later weeks - that's normal.

• A moderate deficit of ~300-500 kcal/day (a loss of ~0.5% bodyweight per week) preserves the most muscle. Crash diets cost muscle and strength.

• **Protein:** 1.6-2.2 g per kg bodyweight daily (0.7-1.0 g per lb), spread over 3-4 meals. This is the single most important nutrition number.

• **Steps over cardio:** walking 8,000-12,000 steps a day burns calories with almost no recovery cost. Add 1-2 short Zone 2 cardio sessions (20-30 min) only if the scale stalls for 2-3 weeks.

• If your recovery tanks (poor sleep, joints aching, lifts falling fast), take a diet break at maintenance calories for 1-2 weeks.

Supplements that actually have evidence

• **Creatine monohydrate** 3-5 g/day, any time. Improves strength, reps and muscle retention. Safe for healthy people; drink plenty of water.

• **Protein powder** only if you can't reach your protein target from food. **Caffeine** 100-200 mg before training is optional. **Vitamin D / omega-3** if blood work or diet suggests you need them.

• Everything else (BCAAs, fat burners, testosterone boosters) is marketing.

Recovery and general health

• **Sleep 7-9 hours.** The biggest recovery lever there is - poor sleep reduces gains and increases injury risk and hunger on a cut.

• **Hydration:** about 2.5-3.5 L/day, more on hot days and heavy training days. **Fibre and veg** at most meals.

• **Stress:** high life stress eats into recovery just like training does. If a week is chaotic, keep the sessions but trim a set or two from isolation lifts rather than skipping them.

• **Alcohol** impairs muscle protein synthesis and sleep - keep it low.

• **Mobility:** 5-10 minutes of hip, thoracic spine and shoulder mobility on rest days is plenty. Hang from a bar daily for 30 sec if you can - great for shoulders and grip.

• **Medical:** get a basic health check (blood pressure, lipids, blood sugar) once a year. Any chest pain, dizziness or fainting during training means stop and see a doctor.

Rest days

• Wed / Fri / Sun are rest days. They are when muscle is rebuilt, not wasted time. Light walking or easy cycling is fine.

• If you must move a session, keep at least one rest day between Day 1-2 and Day 3-4 when possible and avoid more than 2 training days in a row.

08 Injury Prevention & Technique Rules

Train hard, stay healthy, stay consistent

Shoulders (front delt / rotator cuff)

• Front-of-the-shoulder pinching = stop the exercise and reassess. Pressing is your biggest shoulder stressor: incline, flat and overhead all load the front delt.

• **Face pulls and reverse pec deck are not optional** - they balance all your pressing and protect the cuff. Never skip them on a rushed day.

• Keep the incline bench at 30-45 degrees, shoulder blades pinned back and down, elbows ~45-60 degrees from your body. Control the eccentric; don't let the dumbbells drop into the stretch.

• If one press variation hurts, swap to a machine press or a neutral-grip DB press for a few weeks (see Subs).

Lower back and hips

• **RDL:** the moment your lower back rounds, the set is over. It is the highest back-risk exercise in the program - never chase reps once form breaks.

• **Leg press / hack squat:** keep your lower back flat on the pad all the way down; reduce depth if the pelvis tucks under ("butt wink").

• **Seated row:** don't rock back and forth, especially right after RDLs on Day 2. Keep the torso nearly still.

• Brace your abs before every heavy rep (a big breath into the belly, tight midsection).

Knees and elbows

• Knees track over the toes on squat, leg press and split squat; don't let them cave inward. Leg extensions: reduce load if you get front-of-knee pain; use a lighter weight and slower reps.

• Elbow/tendon aches usually come from doing too much new volume at once. Keep skullcrusher/overhead extension elbows pointing forward and use a rope or an EZ bar to ease the wrists.

• **Tendons adapt slower than muscle.** Forearm, calf, curl and ab-wheel work should feel easy in weeks 1-2 on purpose.

Wrists and grip

• Keep wrists straight on presses, curls and carries. Use wrist straps on heavy rows or pulldowns only if grip limits the back from working. Don't strap on forearm exercises or carries (that is the point of them).

• Never fight through sharp, shooting or joint pain. Muscle burn is fine; sharp or pinching pain is a signal to stop and modify.

• If pain lasts more than 1-2 weeks or gets worse, see a physiotherapist or doctor.

Safety checklist

• Use safety stops/pins on leg press and spotters or a safe bail-out on heavy pressing.

• Use a full warm-up on heavy lifts (ramping sets) and a slow bodyweight pattern before leg days.

• Control the lowering (2-3 sec) on every lift; the eccentric builds muscle and protects the joints.

09 Aesthetics, Equipment Swaps & FAQ

Look better, keep it simple, adapt to your gym

What builds the aesthetic look

• **V-taper:** wide lats (pulldowns, pull-ups) + wide shoulders (lateral raises) + small waist. Side delts and lats get the most weekly sets for this reason.

• **Chest:** upper chest shelf from incline pressing (3 sessions), plus a stretch-focused fly for fullness.

• **Arms:** long head of the triceps (overhead work) and long head of the biceps (incline curl) add the most size from the front, side and back views.

• **Legs and calves:** full-range squats, RDLs and calf raises with a pause at the stretch. Skipping legs destroys proportions.

• **Waist:** abs show through low body fat, not endless crunches. A small waist comes from fat loss; avoid heavy weighted side bends.

• **Posture:** rear delts, face pulls and rows fix rounded shoulders; stand tall - good posture alone adds visual size.

• **Visible results timeline:** ~8-12 weeks for first visible changes (strength gains sooner), ~6-12 months for a clearly different physique, assuming consistency, enough protein and sleep.

Equipment swaps for your gym

• **No chest-supported row machine:** Day 2 uses the **Seated Cable Row (V-bar)** - an excellent replacement. For an even closer match, lie face down on an incline bench (30-45 degrees) and row DBs (Incline-Bench Chest-Supported Row); it keeps the lower back out of the exercise after RDLs.

• **No lateral raise machine:** DB lateral raise is a great exercise and stays in the plan. Its one weak spot is that there is no tension at the bottom of the rep, so Day 1 uses the cable version for constant tension. If no cable is available, use a slight forward lean and a 1-sec pause at the top to compensate.

• **No hack squat:** use leg press with low, narrow feet on Day 1 and mid-position feet on Day 3.

• **No pull-up bar:** use wide or neutral-grip lat pulldown (add a 2-sec squeeze at the bottom).

• **No hanging leg raise bar:** reverse crunch on a flat bench or captain's chair leg raise.

• **No preacher bench/machine:** use an incline-bench Spider Curl (chest on a 45-degree bench) or a cable curl with the arm in front of the body.

• **No ab wheel:** cable crunch or a plank with a pelvic tilt for 30-45 sec.

Common questions

• **"Is this really full body?"** Yes. Every session trains legs, push, pull and arms/calves, with a different emphasis each day.

• **"I'm short on time."** Drop the last isolation exercise (ab or forearm work) first, never the compound lifts.

• **"I missed a session."** Do not double up. Pick up with the next scheduled day, keeping at least one rest day.

• **"Should I add more sets?"** Only to a muscle that is lagging after 4-6 weeks of honest effort, 1 set per session at a time.

Exercise order and rest

• Always do the exercises in the order listed - heavy compounds come first while you're fresh, isolation work and supersets later.

• Rest 2-3 min on heavy compounds, 1.5-2 min on rows and isolation, and none inside supersets. Short rest on big lifts reduces strength and growth - take the time you need.

Disclaimer: This program is general fitness information, not medical advice. Consult a doctor before starting if you have a medical condition or injury.